

Worksheet 03-2: Past Perfect vs. Simple Past

Instructions: Read the sentences carefully. Fill in the blanks using the correct form of the verbs in parentheses. Decide whether to use the **Simple Past** (for the main event) or the **Past Perfect** (for an action that happened before another past action).

Exercises (1 - 24)

1. After Bob _____ (hear) the news, he immediately called his sister.
2. By the time the movie started, we _____ (already / buy) our popcorn.
3. Sarah _____ (not realize) that she had left her keys at the office until she reached home.
4. When the police arrived at the scene, the thief _____ (escape).
5. They _____ (live) in London for five years before they moved to Berlin.
6. Richard _____ (drink) a bottle of beer after he _____ (have) his breakfast.
7. Peter suddenly _____ (realize) that he _____ (leave) his cap on the train.
8. Edith _____ (study) French before she _____ (begin) to learn English.
9. After the player _____ (score) a goal, he _____ (play) brilliantly.
10. After we _____ (see) this new film, we _____ (have) an interesting discussion about it.
11. Little Tom _____ (dirty) his trousers before his mother _____ (arrive) home.
12. The workers _____ (make up) their minds before their boss _____ (interview) them.
13. Mary _____ (discover) that Charlie _____ (take) all her money.
14. When they _____ (finish), they _____ (go) home.
15. After Jane _____ (read) a fashion magazine, she _____ (practise) the piano.
16. Conrad _____ (refuse) to admit that he _____ (make) a mistake.
17. Ellen _____ (tell) her teacher that her mother _____ (help) her with her homework.
18. The clerk _____ (work) hard after the director _____ (criticize) him.
19. I _____ (be) sure that he _____ (not / kill) the man.
20. Before I _____ (visit) Mr. Green, I _____ (send) him a telegram.
21. After Molly _____ (break) her engagement, she _____ (go) abroad.
22. John _____ (realize) to his astonishment that he _____ (set) a new world record.
23. Walter _____ (work) as a skilled worker before he _____ (begin) to study architecture.
24. Mrs. Maudling _____ (post) the letter immediately after she _____ (finish) it.